VOL2

VOLUME 2

Physical & Balance Exercises Guide

160 evidence-informed exercises for standing balance, gait, strength, coordination, and fall prevention.

160 Exercises | 5 Sections | Levels 1–3 | Print-Ready

SENIOR ACTIVITY VAULT · PROFESSIONAL EDITION



SECTION 1

Standing Balance

Single-leg stands, tandem stances, weight shifts, reach tests, and foam pad challenges to build static and dynamic standing balance.

- Single-leg and tandem stands
- Forward and lateral reaches
- Foam pad and perturbation drills
- Eyes-closed challenges



Single-Leg Stand

★ Independent

Stand on one leg to improve static balance and ankle stability.

1. Stand behind a sturdy chair, hands resting lightly on the back.
2. Lift your right foot 2–3 inches off the floor.
3. Hold for 10 seconds, breathing steadily.
4. Lower and repeat on the left leg; aim for 3 sets each.

Tandem Stance

★ Independent

Place one foot directly in front of the other to challenge narrow-base balance.

1. Stand tall with feet hip-width apart.
2. Step your right foot forward so the heel touches the left toes.
3. Hold the position for 15 seconds without swaying.
4. Switch foot position and repeat; increase hold time as able.

Weight Shift Side to Side

★ Independent

Slowly transfer body weight from foot to foot to activate lateral balance muscles.

1. Stand with feet shoulder-width apart, arms relaxed.
2. Slowly shift weight to the right foot, lifting the left slightly.
3. Hold 3 seconds, then shift weight to the left.
4. Repeat 10 times each side.

Forward Reach Test

★★ Assisted

Reach forward as far as possible without stepping to measure and train dynamic balance.

1. Stand near a wall for safety, feet shoulder-width apart.
2. Extend both arms in front at shoulder height.
3. Lean forward slowly, reaching as far as comfortable.
4. Return to upright and record reach distance; repeat 5 times.

Lateral Reach

★★ Assisted

Reach sideways while maintaining a stable base of support.

1. Stand with feet shoulder-width apart, one hand on chair if needed.
2. Extend right arm out to the side and lean slightly right.
3. Hold 2 seconds, then return to centre.
4. Repeat 8 times each side.

Foam Pad Stand

★★ Assisted

Standing on a foam pad increases proprioceptive challenge for improved ankle balance.

1. Place a folded towel or foam pad on the floor.
2. Step onto the pad, feet shoulder-width apart, hands near wall.
3. Stand still for 20 seconds, feeling the surface beneath you.
4. Progress to eyes closed for 10 seconds when confident.

Eyes-Closed Stand

★★ Assisted

Removing visual input forces the body to rely on proprioception and vestibular balance.

1. Stand near a wall with feet together.
2. Place hands lightly on the wall, then remove them.
3. Close eyes gently and hold still for 10–15 seconds.
4. Open eyes, rest, and repeat 3 times.

Stork Stand

★★ Assisted

Flex the raised knee to 90 degrees for a more challenging single-leg balance.

1. Stand tall, feet together, holding chair lightly.
2. Lift right knee to hip height, forming a right angle.
3. Hold 10 seconds, focusing on a fixed point ahead.
4. Lower and repeat on the left; work up to 20 seconds.

Clock Reach

★★ Assisted

Reach the lifted foot to imaginary clock positions to challenge multi-directional balance.

1. Stand on left foot; imagine a clock face on the floor.
2. Tap right toes to 12 o'clock, return to centre.
3. Tap to 3 o'clock (side), then 6 o'clock (back), return each time.
4. Repeat full sequence 3 times, then switch standing leg.

Tandem Walk Stance

★ Independent

Hold the tandem (heel-to-toe) position longer to build narrow-base stability.

1. Step right foot directly in front of left, heel touching toes.
2. Release chair support and hold for 20 seconds.
3. Take a small step to the side to reset.
4. Repeat 5 times, alternating which foot is in front.

Hip Abductor Hold

★★ Assisted

Hold the leg abducted to the side to strengthen hip stabilisers crucial for balance.

1. Stand sideways to a chair, left hand on back.
2. Lift right leg out to the side 15–20 cm.
3. Hold 5 seconds, keeping body upright.
4. Return and repeat 10 times; switch sides.

Backward Lean

★★ Assisted

Controlled backward weight shift tests posterior balance reactions.

1. Stand with feet shoulder-width apart, arms folded.
2. Slowly lean body backward from the ankles (not waist).
3. Feel weight shift to heels; hold 3 seconds.
4. Return to neutral; repeat 8 times.

Narrow Base Stand

★ Independent

Bring feet together to reduce base of support and challenge stability.

1. Stand with feet touching side by side, hands near wall.
2. Release wall support and stand for 20 seconds.
3. Rest 10 seconds, then repeat 5 times.
4. Progress by crossing arms over chest when comfortable.

Diagonal Reach

★★ Assisted

Reach diagonally to stimulate rotational balance and cross-body coordination.

1. Stand feet shoulder-width apart.
2. Extend right arm up-right diagonally while shifting weight right.
3. Hold 2 seconds, return to centre.
4. Repeat left arm up-left; do 10 reps each side.

Weight Shift Forward/Back

★ Independent

Shift weight from toes to heels to activate the full balance spectrum.

1. Stand feet hip-width apart, arms by sides.
2. Rise onto toes slowly, hold 3 seconds.
3. Rock back onto heels, toes lifted, hold 3 seconds.
4. Repeat 10 cycles; use chair for safety if needed.

Step Touch Balance

★ Independent

Touch foot to the side and return, pausing on one leg to build dynamic balance.

1. Stand feet together, hands available to chair.
2. Step right foot out, touch floor, then return, pausing 2 seconds.
3. Repeat 10 times right, then 10 times left.
4. Gradually increase pause duration to 5 seconds.

Standing Marching

★ Independent

High-knee marching in place improves dynamic single-leg stance time.

1. Stand behind chair, hands resting lightly on back.
2. Lift right knee to waist height, hold 1 second.
3. Lower and immediately lift left knee.
4. March for 30 seconds; progress to 60 seconds.

Heel Raises

★ Independent

Rising onto toes strengthens calf muscles vital for push-off balance.

1. Stand facing a wall, fingertips touching lightly.
2. Slowly rise onto toes as high as comfortable.
3. Hold at top for 2 seconds.
4. Lower slowly; do 15 repetitions.



Toe Raises

★ Independent

Lifting the toes activates ankle dorsiflexors, reducing trip risk.

1. Stand with heels on floor, back against wall.
2. Lift both forefeet off the floor as high as possible.
3. Hold 2 seconds at top.
4. Lower slowly; complete 15 repetitions.



Side Leg Lift Hold

★★ Assisted

Hold the abducted leg still to build lateral hip and trunk stability.

1. Stand beside chair, left hand on back.
2. Lift right leg to the side about 20 cm off the floor.
3. Hold 8 seconds without tilting the torso.
4. Lower; do 8 reps each side.

Posterior Leg Lift

★★ Assisted

Lift leg behind the body to work glutes and challenge trunk balance.

1. Stand facing chair back, both hands resting on it.
2. Lift right leg straight behind, keeping spine upright.
3. Hold 5 seconds at top.
4. Lower and repeat 10 times; switch legs.

Knee Bend Stand

★ Independent

Shallow mini-squat on both legs to strengthen quads while maintaining balance.

1. Stand feet shoulder-width apart, hands on hips.
2. Bend knees 15–20 degrees (quarter squat).
3. Hold 5 seconds, keeping knees over toes.
4. Straighten and repeat 12 times.

Alphabet Tracing

★★ Assisted

Trace alphabet letters with one foot while standing to combine cognitive and balance tasks.

1. Stand on left foot, right hand near chair.
2. Lift right foot slightly and slowly trace letter A in the air.
3. Continue through the alphabet (or chosen letters).
4. Switch to left foot; rest between letters as needed.

Perturbation Training

★★★ Supported

A partner provides gentle pushes so the participant practises reactive balance.

1. Participant stands feet together, arms crossed.
2. Therapist places hands on shoulders.
3. Therapist applies a gentle push (forward, back, or side).
4. Participant recovers to steady stance before next push.



Bosu Balance Tap

★★★ Supported

Tap a domed balance cushion with alternating feet to train reactive stepping.

1. Place balance cushion (or folded mat) in front of participant.
2. Stand facing the cushion, one hand near wall.
3. Tap right foot onto cushion and return, then left foot.
4. Alternate for 20 taps; increase speed as confidence grows.



Timed Up and Balance

★★ Assisted

After rising from a chair, hold a steady stance for 10 seconds before walking.

1. Sit in a standard chair, arms crossed.
2. Stand up without using hands if possible.
3. Pause standing, feet shoulder-width, for 10 seconds.
4. Sit back down controlled; repeat 5 times.

Narrow Tandem Eyes Closed

★★★ Supported

Combines tandem stance with eyes closed for a high-challenge proprioception drill.

1. Step into tandem stance (right foot in front of left).
2. Place hands lightly on wall, then remove.
3. Close eyes gently and hold for 10 seconds.
4. Open eyes; repeat with opposite foot forward.

Dynamic Weight Shift Circle

★★ Assisted

Trace a wide circle with body weight to challenge balance in all directions.

1. Stand feet shoulder-width apart, arms extended to sides.
2. Slowly shift weight forward, then right, then back, then left in a circle.
3. Complete one full circle in 8 seconds.
4. Reverse direction; repeat 5 circles each way.

Step-Over Obstacle

★★ Assisted

Step over a low foam pool noodle to practise high stepping and balance recovery.

1. Place a foam noodle on the floor.
2. Stand behind it, hands available to wall.
3. Step right leg over slowly, then bring left leg over.
4. Turn around and repeat; do 10 crossings.

Seated to Standing Balance

★ Independent

Practise the critical transition from sitting to balanced standing.

1. Sit at the front edge of a chair, feet flat.
2. Lean forward slightly and push through heels to stand.
3. Pause in standing for 5 seconds before moving.
4. Sit back slowly; repeat 10 times.

Star Excursion

★★★ Supported

Reach in 8 directions from a single-leg stance to assess and train dynamic balance.

1. Stand on left foot; imagine a star on the floor.
2. Tap right toes to each of 8 positions (N, NE, E, SE, S, SW, W, NW).
3. Return to centre after each tap.
4. Complete full star; switch legs.

Bubble-Level Stand

★★ Assisted

Hold a flat tray with a small water-filled cup to maintain levelled balance with feedback.

1. Fill a small cup 2/3 full of water; place on a tray.
2. Hold tray in both hands at waist level.
3. Stand feet together and balance without spilling.
4. Close eyes for 5 seconds as an added challenge.



SECTION 2

Gait & Walking

Heel-toe walking, obstacle navigation, backward walking, stair practice, and tray-carry drills to restore confident, safe gait.

- Heel-toe and tandem walk
- Obstacle and cone courses
- Stair and curb practice
- Dual-task gait training





Heel-Toe Walk

★ Independent

Walk placing the heel of the front foot directly against the toes of the back foot.

1. Mark a 3-metre line on the floor with tape.
2. Walk along the line, placing heel against toes each step.
3. Arms extended for balance if needed.
4. Complete 5 lengths, rest, repeat.



Obstacle Course Walk

★★ Assisted

Navigate around chairs and cones to practise obstacle avoidance while walking.

1. Set up 4 chairs/cones in a staggered line 1 metre apart.
2. Walk around each obstacle, stepping wide if needed.
3. Reverse direction and return.
4. Increase pace slightly each round.



Backward Walking

★★ Assisted

Walk backward slowly to activate posterior leg muscles and challenge balance control.

1. Stand in a clear corridor or room, near a wall.
2. Look over right shoulder to check path is clear.
3. Take 10 small, slow backward steps.
4. Pause, turn, and repeat in the other direction.



Sideways Stepping

★ Independent

Step sideways using a step-together-step pattern to strengthen hip abductors.

1. Stand beside a long wall, right side facing direction of travel.
2. Step right foot to the side, bring left foot to meet it.
3. Continue 10 side-steps right, then reverse.
4. Do 3 lengths each direction.



Tray Carry Walk

★★ Assisted

Carry a light tray while walking to practise dual-task balance.

1. Fill a small cup halfway and place on a tray.
2. Hold tray level at waist with both hands.
3. Walk a 5-metre straight path and back without spilling.
4. Repeat 3 times; increase distance as confidence grows.



Stair Practice

★★ Assisted

Ascend and descend 4–6 stairs with a rail to maintain safe stair mobility.

1. Stand at base of stairs, hold handrail firmly.
2. Step up with stronger leg first, then bring other foot to same step.
3. Pause at top, assess balance.
4. Descend leading with weaker leg, trailing with stronger.



Figure-of-Eight Walk

★★ Assisted

Walk in a figure-of-eight pattern around two markers to practise turning.

1. Place two chairs 2 metres apart.
2. Walk around the right chair, then loop around the left chair.
3. Continue for 5 full figure-of-eights.
4. Reverse direction; aim for smooth, controlled turns.



High-Step Walk

★★ Assisted

Lift knees high with each step to improve foot clearance and reduce trip risk.

1. Walk along a 5-metre path.
2. Lift each knee to hip height as you step forward.
3. Keep torso upright; swing arms naturally.
4. Complete 4 lengths; rest between lengths.



Narrow Path Walk

★★ Assisted

Walk along a 20 cm wide taped path to practise reduced base-of-support gait.

1. Lay two parallel tape lines 20 cm apart on floor.
2. Walk between the lines without stepping outside them.
3. Keep chin level; look ahead not at feet.
4. Increase pace or close eyes briefly once proficient.



Metronome Walk

★ Independent

Walk in time with a steady beat to improve gait rhythm and step timing.

1. Set a metronome or phone timer to 60 bpm.
2. Take one step with each beat, left-right alternating.
3. Walk for 30 seconds, rest, repeat.
4. Increase tempo to 80 bpm as ability improves.



Cone Weave

★★ Assisted

Weave between a row of cones to challenge directional change and speed.

1. Place 6 cones in a straight line, 0.5 m apart.
2. Walk weaving between cones, keeping close to each.
3. Return weaving back to start.
4. Repeat 5 times; time yourself and aim to improve.



Stop-and-Go Walk

★ Independent

Stop suddenly on command to practise emergency deceleration and balance.

1. Walk at a comfortable pace along a corridor.
2. When instructor says 'Stop', halt immediately.
3. Hold still for 3 seconds, then resume.
4. Repeat 10 stop commands in a 10-metre walk.



Dual-Task Walk

★★ Assisted

Walk while performing a counting task to practise divided attention gait.

1. Walk along a 6-metre path.
2. Simultaneously count backward from 20 aloud.
3. If you stop counting, pause walking until you find the number.
4. Complete 3 lengths; progress to counting in 3s.



Stepping Over Lines

★ Independent

Step over floor lines as if they are obstacles to practise controlled step height.

1. Place 5 tape lines on the floor 60 cm apart.
2. Walk over each line with a deliberate lift of the foot.
3. Turn around and walk back over the lines.
4. Repeat 5 passes.



Varied Surface Walk

★★★ Supported

Walk across different textures (mat, foam, grass) to adapt balance strategies.

1. Prepare three 1-metre sections: smooth floor, foam mat, outdoor grass or carpet.
2. Walk slowly across each section, adjusting foot placement.
3. Hold wall for support when needed.
4. Complete 3 passes across all surfaces.



Sideways Crossover Step

★★ Assisted

Cross one foot in front of or behind the other while moving sideways to improve coordination.

1. Stand in open space, arms relaxed.
2. Cross right foot in front of left, step left with left foot.
3. Cross right foot behind left, step left with left foot.
4. Continue for 4 metres; reverse direction.



Corner-Turning Walk

★★ Assisted

Practise making 90-degree turns safely using a wide arc technique.

1. Walk along a corridor to a corner.
2. Begin the turn 0.5 m before the corner.
3. Sweep wide arc turn, keeping feet clear.
4. Alternate turning left and right, 10 turns each.



Carrying Object Walk

★★ Assisted

Walk while carrying a bag or book to practise asymmetric load balance.

1. Hold a light book or bag in one hand.
2. Walk 6 metres at normal pace.
3. Swap item to the other hand and return.
4. Repeat 5 times each hand.



Incline Walk

★★ Assisted

Walk up and down a ramp to practise graded terrain gait.

1. Use a gentle ramp (5–10 degree incline).
2. Ascend slowly, leaning slightly forward.
3. Descend leaning slightly back, shorter steps.
4. Complete 5 ascents and descents.



Stride-Length Walk

★ Independent

Consciously lengthen each stride to improve gait efficiency and trunk stability.

1. Walk along a 6-metre path.
2. Aim to step further than usual, heel striking first.
3. Count steps needed to cover the distance.
4. Work to reduce step count (longer strides) over sessions.



Walking Start-Stop Jump

★★★ Supported

Transition from walking to a momentary double-leg pause position to build reactive control.

1. Walk at moderate pace.
2. On signal, pause on both feet simultaneously.
3. Hold stance 3 seconds with feet shoulder-width.
4. Resume walking; practice 10 pause transitions.



Backward Tandem Walk

★★★ Supported

Walk backward in a tandem (heel-to-toe) pattern to combine two balance challenges.

1. Stand in tandem stance, left foot behind right.
2. Step backward, placing left heel against right toes.
3. Continue for 5 backward tandem steps.
4. Turn and repeat; hold wall if needed.



Sideways Shuffle with Ball

★★ Assisted

Shuffle sideways while bouncing a light ball to combine gait and upper-limb coordination.

1. Hold a light foam ball, stand at one side of room.
2. Shuffle 4 metres sideways, bouncing ball each step.
3. Reach end, turn, shuffle back.
4. Repeat 4 widths; drop the ball is OK, just retrieve and continue.



Timed 10-Metre Walk

★ Independent

Walk 10 metres at comfortable pace; timed to track gait speed progress.

1. Mark a 10-metre course on the floor.
2. Walk at your comfortable pace, not rushing.
3. Therapist times walk from crossing the start to crossing the end.
4. Record time; repeat monthly to track improvement.



Stepping-Stone Walk

★★ Assisted

Step onto paper 'stones' in varying patterns to practise precision foot placement.

1. Place 8 paper squares in a staggered pattern on the floor.
2. Step only on the paper squares, no touching the floor.
3. Progress through the course and back.
4. Rearrange stones for a new pattern each session.



Walk-and-Turn

★★ Assisted

Walk 3 metres, turn 180 degrees, and return to start; tests gait and turning balance.

1. Walk to a mark 3 metres away at normal pace.
2. Turn 180 degrees using small steps.
3. Walk back to start.
4. Repeat 8 times; aim for smooth turns.



Slalom Walk

★★ Assisted

Slalom between a series of closely spaced markers using controlled footwork.

1. Place 8 markers in a line 0.4 m apart.
2. Walk slalom, alternating sides of each marker.
3. Maintain upright posture; avoid touching markers.
4. Repeat 4 times; increase speed each pass.



Shadow Walking

★ Independent

Follow a partner, mirroring their pace and direction changes to improve reactive gait.

1. Pair participants; one leads, one follows 1 metre behind.
2. Leader varies pace and makes direction changes.
3. Follower mirrors changes as quickly as possible.
4. Swap roles after 2 minutes.



Stair-Step Tap

★★ Assisted

Tap the foot on a bottom stair tread repeatedly to build step accuracy and leg strength.

1. Stand in front of bottom stair, holding rail.
2. Tap right foot on the tread and return 10 times.
3. Tap left foot on the tread and return 10 times.
4. Perform 3 sets each leg.



Walking with Head Turns

★★ Assisted

Turn head side to side while walking to train vestibular-gait integration.

1. Walk at normal pace along a 6-metre course.
2. Slowly turn head right and hold 2 steps, then left 2 steps.
3. Keep walking without slowing; use wall if dizzy.
4. Complete 4 lengths.



Rhythm Marching Walk

★ Independent

Walk with exaggerated arm swing to music to improve cadence and coordination.

1. Put on music at about 80–100 bpm.
2. Walk in time to the beat, swinging opposite arm with each step.
3. Lift knees slightly higher than usual.
4. Continue for one full song or 3 minutes.



Step Width Variation

★ Independent

Alternate between wide-stance and narrow-stance steps to practise adaptive gait.

1. Walk 2 steps with very wide stance (feet 40 cm apart).
2. Walk 2 steps with narrow stance (feet 5 cm apart).
3. Continue alternating for 8 metres.
4. Repeat 3 lengths; use this in varying environments.



SECTION 3

Mobility & Strength

Chair stands, wall sits, step-ups, leg raises, and resistance-band work to build the lower and upper limb strength needed for independent mobility.

- Chair stands and mini-squats
- Step-ups and wall sits
- Resistance band upper limb
- Seated and standing leg work



💪

Chair Stand

★ Independent

Rise from a chair without using hands to build quad and glute strength essential for mobility.

1. Sit at front edge of chair, feet flat and hip-width apart.
2. Lean forward slightly and shift weight to feet.
3. Push through heels and stand tall.
4. Lower slowly back to seated; repeat 10 times.

💪

Wall Sit

★★ Assisted

Hold a seated position against a wall to build sustained quad endurance.

1. Stand with back against a smooth wall.
2. Slide down until thighs are parallel to the floor (or as able).
3. Hold for 15 seconds, breathing steadily.
4. Slide back up; rest 30 seconds; repeat 3 times.

💪

Step-Up

★★ Assisted

Step up onto a low step to build functional leg strength for climbing stairs.

1. Stand in front of a 15–20 cm step or bottom stair, holding rail.
2. Step up with right foot, then bring left foot to meet it.
3. Step down right foot, then left foot.
4. Repeat 10 times; switch lead leg each set.

💪

Seated Leg Extension

★ Independent

Extend the knee from a seated position to strengthen the quadriceps.

1. Sit upright in chair, feet flat.
2. Lift right leg, extending knee fully.
3. Hold 3 seconds with knee straight.
4. Lower slowly; do 12 reps each leg.



Standing Hip Flexion

★ Independent

Lift the thigh to hip height while standing to strengthen hip flexors.

1. Stand beside chair, one hand resting on back.
2. Lift right knee to hip level.
3. Hold 2 seconds.
4. Lower; repeat 12 times each leg.



Resistance Band Bicep Curl

★ Independent

Curl the arm against resistance to maintain upper-arm strength for daily lifting tasks.

1. Sit or stand, step on a light resistance band.
2. Hold each end of band, palms up.
3. Curl hands to shoulders, keeping elbows at sides.
4. Lower slowly; do 12 reps.

💪

Resistance Band Row

★★ Assisted

Pull a band toward the torso to strengthen back muscles for posture and transfers.

1. Sit, loop band around a door handle at waist height.
2. Hold one end in each hand, arms extended.
3. Pull elbows back, squeezing shoulder blades together.
4. Return slowly; do 12 reps.

💪

Calf Raise with Step

★ Independent

Rise onto toes on a step for greater range and progressive calf loading.

1. Stand on bottom stair, heels hanging off edge, rail held.
2. Lower heels below step level slowly.
3. Rise onto toes as high as possible.
4. Lower slowly; repeat 15 times.

💪

Lateral Step-Up

★★ Assisted

Step sideways onto a low step to target the hip abductors and lateral leg muscles.

1. Stand beside a low step, right side toward it.
2. Step right foot onto the step.
3. Lift left foot up to meet it.
4. Step left foot down, then right; 10 reps each side.

💪

Glute Bridge

★ Independent

Lie on back and press hips upward to strengthen glutes and core for standing and walking.

1. Lie on back on a mat, knees bent, feet flat.
2. Press heels into mat and lift hips until body is straight from knees to shoulders.
3. Hold 3 seconds at top.
4. Lower slowly; repeat 12 times.



Seated Marching

★ Independent

Lift knees alternately while seated to warm up hip flexors and improve seated mobility.

1. Sit upright at front of chair.
2. Lift right knee as high as comfortable.
3. Lower and lift left knee.
4. Continue alternating for 30 seconds.



Shoulder Press Seated

★ Independent

Press light weights or a water bottle overhead to maintain shoulder strength.

1. Sit tall, hold a 0.5 kg weight or bottle in each hand at shoulder height.
2. Press both arms overhead until elbows near straight.
3. Lower slowly to start.
4. Do 12 repetitions.

💪

Chest Press with Band

★★ Assisted

Press arms forward against resistance to strengthen chest and shoulder muscles.

1. Sit in chair, loop band around back of chair at shoulder height.
2. Hold each end of band, elbows bent at 90 degrees.
3. Push hands forward until arms extended.
4. Return slowly; do 12 reps.

💪

Leg Curl Standing

★★ Assisted

Curl the heel toward the buttock while standing to strengthen hamstrings.

1. Stand beside chair, both hands on back.
2. Bend right knee, bringing heel toward buttock.
3. Hold 2 seconds at top.
4. Lower slowly; 12 reps each leg.



Sit to Stand with Pause

★★ Assisted

Add a brief pause in each phase to build strength and control throughout the movement.

1. Sit at front of chair, feet flat.
2. Lean forward and pause 2 seconds before rising.
3. Stand fully and pause 3 seconds.
4. Lower slowly, pause at edge of chair before fully sitting.



Wall Push-Up

★ Independent

Perform a push-up against a wall for upper body strengthening with minimal fall risk.

1. Stand arm's length from wall, palms flat at shoulder height.
2. Bend elbows, lowering chest toward wall.
3. Push back to start position.
4. Do 12 repetitions.

💪

Band Shoulder Rotation

★ Independent

Rotate the shoulder against light resistance to maintain rotator cuff strength.

1. Hold band in both hands at waist height, elbows bent 90°.
2. Keep elbows at sides; rotate forearms outward.
3. Return to midline slowly.
4. Repeat 12 times.

💪

Hip Extension Kickback

★★ Assisted

Kick the leg straight behind while standing to target gluteus maximus.

1. Stand facing chair, both hands resting on back.
2. Lift right leg straight behind, keeping knee straight.
3. Hold 2 seconds.
4. Lower slowly; 10 reps each leg.



Seated Tricep Press

★ Independent

Press down on chair armrests to lift the body, strengthening triceps for transfers.

1. Sit in a chair with sturdy armrests.
2. Place hands on armrests, elbows bent.
3. Push down to straighten elbows and lift body slightly.
4. Hold 2 seconds, lower; do 10 reps.



Mini-Squat

★ Independent

A shallow squat strengthens lower limbs while remaining accessible for most seniors.

1. Stand feet shoulder-width apart, arms extended forward for balance.
2. Bend knees 20–30 degrees slowly.
3. Hold 3 seconds at lowest position.
4. Straighten; repeat 12 times.



Forward Lunge (Assisted)

★★★ Supported

Step forward into a partial lunge to build single-leg strength and flexibility.

1. Stand near wall or rail for support.
2. Step right foot forward 50 cm.
3. Lower back knee toward floor (as able).
4. Push through front heel to return; 8 reps each leg.



Seated Row with Band

★★ Assisted

Pull a band to the chest while seated to maintain back strength and posture.

1. Sit at front of chair; loop band around both feet.
2. Hold both ends, arms extended.
3. Pull elbows back past hips.
4. Return slowly; 12 reps.

💪

Ankle Dorsiflexion Strengthening

★ Independent

Resist ankle lift with a band to strengthen dorsiflexors and prevent tripping.

1. Sit in chair; loop band over foot and hold ends.
2. Lift foot upward against band resistance.
3. Hold 2 seconds.
4. Lower slowly; 12 reps each foot.

💪

Side-Lying Hip Abduction

★ Independent

Lift leg sideways while lying down to safely strengthen the hip abductors.

1. Lie on left side on mat, legs straight.
2. Lift right leg 30 cm keeping toes pointed forward.
3. Hold 3 seconds.
4. Lower slowly; 12 reps each side.



Seated Knee Extension with Weight

★★ Assisted

Add an ankle weight to seated leg extension to progressively load the quadriceps.

1. Attach 0.5 kg ankle weight to right leg.
2. Sit upright, lift right leg to straight.
3. Hold 5 seconds.
4. Lower slowly; 12 reps; switch legs.



Standing Hip Circle

★ Independent

Circle the hip joint to lubricate and mobilise the hip in functional movement.

1. Stand beside chair, one hand on back.
2. Lift right knee and trace a wide circle outward.
3. Complete 5 circles outward, then 5 inward.
4. Repeat on left hip.



Grip Strengthening

★ Independent

Squeeze a foam ball to maintain hand grip strength important for daily activities.

1. Hold a soft foam ball or rolled washcloth in right hand.
2. Squeeze as firmly as comfortable.
3. Hold 5 seconds.
4. Release and repeat 15 times; switch hands.



Seated Leg Press Simulation

★★ Assisted

Press heels into the floor while seated as if pushing away a weight to activate quads.

1. Sit upright, feet flat and slightly forward.
2. Press heels into floor firmly for 5 seconds.
3. Release and relax 3 seconds.
4. Repeat 15 times; feel quad engagement.

💪

Resistance Band Pull-Apart

★ Independent

Pull a band apart at chest height to strengthen the rear deltoids and improve posture.

1. Hold band in both hands, arms extended forward at shoulder height.
2. Pull hands apart, stretching band across chest.
3. Hold 2 seconds at full stretch.
4. Return slowly; 15 reps.

💪

Step Touch with Arm Swing

★ Independent

Combine rhythmic side-step with large arm swings for full-body functional training.

1. Stand feet together, arms relaxed.
2. Step right foot out, simultaneously swing both arms up.
3. Bring left foot to right, lower arms.
4. Continue for 20 reps each direction.

💪

Chair-Assisted Squat

★★ Assisted

Use a chair behind you for safety confidence while performing a deeper squat.

1. Place chair behind you; stand in front of it, feet shoulder-width.
2. Reach arms forward and lower as if sitting, stopping 5 cm from chair.
3. Hold 2 seconds.
4. Push through heels to stand; 10 reps.

💪

Seated Hip Hinge

★ Independent

Hinge forward at the hips while seated to activate hamstrings and practise safe bending.

1. Sit at front of chair, feet flat, spine tall.
2. Hinge forward from hips (not waist), keeping back flat.
3. Lower torso until parallel to floor or as able.
4. Return to upright; repeat 10 times.



SECTION 4

Coordination

Ball tossing, cone weaving, coordination ladders, and mirror movements to sharpen hand-eye coordination and inter-limb timing.

- Ball catch and throw
- Cone weave and peg tasks
- Rhythm and clapping games
- Bilateral coordination drills



🎯

Ball Toss and Catch

★ Independent

Toss a soft ball overhead and catch it to improve hand-eye coordination and reaction.

1. Sit or stand, holding a soft foam ball.
2. Toss ball gently overhead about 30 cm.
3. Catch with both hands.
4. Repeat 20 times; increase height gradually.

🎯

Partner Ball Pass

★ Independent

Pass a ball back and forth with a partner to build cooperative coordination.

1. Two participants sit 1.5 metres apart.
2. Toss ball gently to partner's hands.
3. Partner catches and passes back.
4. Increase distance by 0.5 m each round.



Balloon Tap

★ Independent

Keep a balloon in the air using taps to improve reaction time with a very safe object.

1. Stand or sit, inflate a balloon.
2. Tap balloon upward gently to keep aloft.
3. Alternate hands with each tap.
4. Count consecutive taps before balloon touches floor.



Cone Weave Carry

★★ Assisted

Carry a ball around cones to combine coordination, balance, and spatial awareness.

1. Set 5 cones in a line 0.5 m apart.
2. Walk weaving between cones carrying a ball in both hands.
3. Return weaving back to start.
4. Repeat 5 times; try with one hand.

Beanbag Toss to Target

★ Independent

Throw beanbags into a target ring to practise upper-limb aiming.

1. Place a hula hoop or target ring on the floor 1.5 m away.
2. Toss beanbag underhand, aiming for centre.
3. Score a point for each target hit.
4. Play 5 rounds of 5 throws.

Mirror Movement

★ Independent

Mirror a partner's arm movements to improve attention and bilateral coordination.

1. Sit facing a partner 1 metre apart.
2. One person leads slow arm movements.
3. Follower copies every movement as if a mirror.
4. Swap leader every 60 seconds.

Reaction Ball Drop

★★ Assisted

Catch a dropped ball as quickly as possible to improve reaction speed.

1. Therapist holds a ball at shoulder height.
2. Participant sits or stands with hands ready below.
3. Therapist drops ball without warning.
4. Participant catches it before second bounce; repeat 10 times.

Peg Placement

★ Independent

Place pegs into a pegboard quickly and accurately to build fine motor coordination.

1. Set out a pegboard with 20 holes and 20 pegs.
2. Place all pegs into board as fast as comfortable.
3. Remove all pegs and repeat.
4. Time each trial; aim to improve.

Coordination Ladder Stepping

★★ Assisted

Step through a flat agility ladder on the floor to practise precise foot placement.

1. Lay a flat agility ladder on the floor.
2. Step both feet into first square, then second.
3. Continue through all squares.
4. Repeat 5 passes; try side-stepping pass.

Juggling Scarves

★ Independent

Toss and catch flowing scarves to develop tracking and bilateral hand coordination.

1. Hold a light scarf in each hand.
2. Toss right scarf upward, then toss left scarf, catch right.
3. Continue the cascade pattern.
4. Practice for 2 minutes; rest and repeat.

Clap Pattern

★ Independent

Repeat a rhythmic clapping pattern to challenge auditory-motor coordination.

1. Instructor claps a 4-beat pattern (e.g., 2 fast, 2 slow).
2. Participant repeats pattern exactly.
3. Increase pattern length each round.
4. Try with eyes closed for extra challenge.

Colour-Target Throw

★ Independent

Toss coloured beanbags to matching colour targets to practise colour and coordination.

1. Place three coloured circles on floor: red, blue, yellow.
2. Instructor calls a colour.
3. Participant throws matching-coloured beanbag to that circle.
4. Play 20 rounds; keep score.

Seated Basketball Toss

★ Independent

Shoot a foam ball into a low basket to practise aiming and arm coordination.

1. Sit 1.5 metres from a low basket or box.
2. Hold foam ball in dominant hand.
3. Aim and toss ball into basket.
4. Attempt 10 shots; record score.

Pen Relay

★★ Assisted

Pass a pen from hand to hand in a figure-of-eight around a knee to build bilateral coordination.

1. Sit upright, hold pen in right hand.
2. Pass pen under right knee to left hand.
3. Pass pen over left knee back to right.
4. Continue for 30 seconds without dropping.

Two-Ball Bounce

★★ Assisted

Bounce two balls simultaneously (one each hand) to challenge bilateral motor control.

1. Stand, hold one foam ball in each hand.
2. Bounce right ball and immediately bounce left ball.
3. Maintain an alternating rhythm.
4. Continue for 20 bounces; try simultaneous bounce.

Reaction Stepping

★★ Assisted

Step to colour-coded floor markers on cue to combine visual reaction and leg coordination.

1. Place three coloured paper squares around participant's feet.
2. Instructor calls a colour.
3. Participant steps to that square and returns.
4. Call 15 colours in 30 seconds.

Stacking Cups

★ Independent

Stack and unstack plastic cups as quickly as possible to improve bimanual coordination.

1. Set out 10 plastic cups on table.
2. Stack all cups into one column as fast as possible.
3. Unstack and space again.
4. Time the task; aim to beat your record.

Figure-of-Eight Ball Roll

★ Independent

Roll a ball around two feet in a figure-of-eight to practise fine dexterity.

1. Sit upright, place a tennis ball in front of feet.
2. Nudge ball around right foot, then left foot, in a figure-of-eight.
3. Continue for 1 minute.
4. Try with a smaller ball as skill improves.

🎯

Coin Sort

★ Independent

Sort mixed coins into denominations as fast as possible to train fine motor speed.

1. Mix 20 coins of different sizes on a table.
2. Sort into groups by denomination.
3. Time the task; record result.
4. Repeat 3 times and compare times.

🎯

Dot-to-Dot Drawing

★ Independent

Complete a large-print dot-to-dot picture to maintain hand-eye coordination.

1. Provide a large-print dot-to-dot sheet.
2. Hold pencil in dominant hand.
3. Connect dots in sequence without lifting pencil.
4. Colour completed image.



Catching with One Hand

★★ Assisted

Catch a thrown ball with one hand to develop independent limb coordination.

1. Stand 2 metres from a partner.
2. Partner throws ball to dominant hand.
3. Catch with one hand only.
4. Swap to non-dominant hand; 10 catches each.



Rhythmic Drumming

★ Independent

Tap rhythms on a drum pad to improve bilateral timing and motor sequencing.

1. Sit at a drum pad or table surface.
2. Instructor taps a 4-beat pattern.
3. Participant repeats pattern with both hands.
4. Increase speed gradually; aim for smooth rhythm.

Thread the Needle

★★ Assisted

Thread large-eyed needles to challenge fine pincer grip and hand-eye precision.

1. Provide large plastic needles and thick yarn.
2. Thread yarn through needle eye.
3. Remove yarn and repeat with other hand.
4. Complete 10 threads; time each attempt.

Ball Dribble Seated

★★ Assisted

Dribble a ball on the floor while seated to practise controlled repetitive hand movement.

1. Sit at front of chair, dominant hand holding ball.
2. Dribble ball on floor in front consistently.
3. Continue for 15 bounces without stopping.
4. Switch to non-dominant hand.

Throwing and Catching with Scarves

★ Independent

Toss and catch flowing scarves to develop tracking with a slow-moving object.

1. Hold one scarf in right hand.
2. Toss upward and catch with left hand.
3. Toss back with left, catch with right.
4. Continue 20 exchanges.

Eye-Hand Tracking

★ Independent

Track a slowly moving ball with eyes and point to its position to maintain oculomotor coordination.

1. Therapist slowly moves a bright ball in front of the participant.
2. Participant follows ball with eyes without moving head.
3. Point to ball position every 5 seconds.
4. Repeat 3 minutes in varied directions.

Simon Says Movements

★ Independent

Follow Simon Says commands to practise rapid motor response to verbal instruction.

1. Instructor gives commands e.g. 'Simon Says touch your nose'.
2. Participant responds only to commands preceded by 'Simon Says'.
3. Play for 5 minutes; count errors.
4. Increase speed of commands as ability grows.

Mirrored Clapping

★ Independent

Clap hands in time with a partner's mirror pattern to build rhythmic coordination.

1. Sit facing partner 1 metre apart.
2. One person claps a slow steady beat.
3. Other mirrors, matching pace and rhythm.
4. Gradually introduce variations; swap leader.

Pom-Pom Tong Transfer

★★ Assisted

Use tongs to transfer pom-poms between containers to build grip and precision.

1. Place two cups and 10 pom-poms on a table.
2. Use kitchen tongs to transfer pom-poms one by one.
3. Switch hands halfway.
4. Time each full transfer; aim to improve.

Leg-Tap Coordination

★ Independent

Alternate tapping right hand on left knee and left hand on right knee to cross-coordinate.

1. Sit upright, hands on thighs.
2. Tap right hand to left knee.
3. Tap left hand to right knee.
4. Increase speed over 30 seconds.

Zigzag Ball Roll

★★ Assisted

Roll a ball in a zigzag between floor markers using a stick or foot to practise precision.

1. Place 5 cones in a zigzag pattern.
2. Sit or stand, use a foam roller or foot to roll ball between cones.
3. Reach end, reverse direction.
4. Repeat 4 passes; improve accuracy.

Directional Arrow Walk

★★ Assisted

Follow floor arrows indicating direction to practise quick visual-motor response.

1. Place 10 arrow signs on floor pointing in various directions.
2. Walk to each arrow and turn in the indicated direction.
3. Continue until all arrows followed.
4. Rearrange arrows for each session.



SECTION 5

Fall Prevention

Safe landing practice, floor-rise techniques, reactive stepping, and home hazard education to reduce fall risk and build post-fall confidence.

- Safe landing and floor-rise
- Reactive stepping drills
- Environmental awareness
- Balance perturbation training



Safe Landing Technique

★★★ Supported

Practise controlled lowering to the floor to reduce injury risk in an actual fall.

1. Therapist demonstrates: bend knees, drop to side, protect head with arm.
2. Participant practises on thick gym mat.
3. Practise until technique feels natural.
4. Repeat 5 times each side; always with therapist present.

Getting Up from the Floor

★★★ Supported

Learn the safest method to rise from the floor after a fall.

1. Lie on back on mat.
2. Roll to one side and push up to hands and knees.
3. Bring one foot forward, place hand on nearby chair.
4. Push to standing using chair for support.

Rapid Stepping

★★ Assisted

Take rapid small steps in response to a balance perturbation to practise recovery stepping.

1. Stand feet together, hands near wall.
2. Therapist provides a light push sideways.
3. Take rapid small steps to recover balance.
4. Practise 10 perturbations; alternate directions.

Ankle Strategy Drill

★★ Assisted

Practise using ankle movement (not stepping) to recover from small swaying imbalance.

1. Stand feet together, arms at sides.
2. Therapist slowly tilts participant 5 degrees forward.
3. Participant recovers using ankle dorsiflexion only (no stepping).
4. Practise 8 times forward, 8 backward.

Hip Strategy Drill

★★ Assisted

Practise using a hip flex to counter a larger balance disturbance without stepping.

1. Stand feet shoulder-width, on foam pad.
2. Therapist tilts participant 10 degrees.
3. Participant recovers by flexing at the hip (trunk forward).
4. Practise 8 times each direction.

Stepping Strategy Drill

★★ Assisted

Take a protective step in the correct direction when balance recovery requires a step.

1. Stand feet together, near wall.
2. Therapist applies forward push.
3. Participant takes a large step forward to catch balance.
4. Practise forward, backward, and side pushes.

Trip-Recovery Simulation

★★★ Supported

Simulate stumbling on a low obstacle to practise automatic recovery stepping.

1. Walk toward a low 2 cm platform on floor.
2. Let right toe catch the platform edge lightly.
3. Practise taking a recovery step to avoid falling.
4. Therapist stands nearby; repeat 5 times each foot.

Tandem Standing Perturbation

★★★ Supported

Receive perturbations while in tandem stance to practise narrow-base fall recovery.

1. Stand in tandem stance, right foot forward.
2. Therapist applies gentle lateral pushes.
3. Participant holds stance or takes recovery step.
4. 10 perturbations; switch stance foot.

Treadmill Safety Walk

★★ Assisted

Walk at slow speed on treadmill to practise recovering step timing in a controlled setting.

1. Set treadmill to 0.5 km/h; participant holds rails.
2. Walk without gripping rails after 30 seconds if stable.
3. Therapist can vary speed slightly to create subtle challenges.
4. Walk 5 minutes total.

Floor-Rise Practice

★★★ Supported

Practise the floor-to-chair transfer repeatedly to build confidence and technique.

1. Participant kneels on mat beside chair.
2. Hands on seat, bring one foot forward.
3. Push to standing using arm and leg strength.
4. Return to kneeling slowly; repeat 5 times.

Darkness Walk

★★ Assisted

Walk a familiar short path with reduced lighting to practise relying on non-visual cues.

1. In a safe corridor, reduce lighting (not complete darkness).
2. Walk 6 metres to a known landmark and back.
3. Keep one hand near wall without touching.
4. Discuss strategies used; repeat 3 passes.

Curb-Step Practice

★★ Assisted

Step up and down a 15 cm curb with rail support to maintain community walking skill.

1. Stand at curb edge, holding rail or wall.
2. Step up with stronger leg first.
3. Pause on top to confirm balance.
4. Step down slowly with weaker leg first.

Reactive Balance Platform

★★★ Supported

Stand on a wobble board and react to tilts to train rapid reflexive balance responses.

1. Step onto wobble board, feet shoulder-width.
2. Allow board to tilt slightly; correct it.
3. Hold controlled position for 20 seconds.
4. Therapist can add light pushes; do 5 rounds.

Seated Emergency Call Drill

★ Independent

Practise calling for help from the floor to reduce fear and panic in a real fall.

1. Sit on mat at floor level.
2. Demonstrate how to call out loudly for help.
3. Practise pressing a dummy emergency button.
4. Discuss where call systems are located at home.

Near-Fall Freeze Training

★★ Assisted

Practise pausing and stabilising immediately when feeling off-balance to prevent stumble progression.

1. Walk at normal pace.
2. On command, freeze immediately without stepping.
3. Hold still for 5 seconds, confirming balance.
4. Resume; repeat 8 freeze commands per session.

Protective Arm Reaction

★★ Assisted

Practise extending arms rapidly to protect against impact in a simulated forward fall.

1. Lean over a padded surface (thick mat on table).
2. Let body slowly tip forward.
3. Extend arms to catch body on mat.
4. Practise controlled tip-and-catch 5 times.

Bed Transfer Practice

★ Independent

Practise safely getting in and out of bed to prevent bedroom falls.

1. Sit on edge of bed, feet flat.
2. Lower to lying by bending elbows and rolling to side.
3. Roll back to sitting using arms to push.
4. Stand using hands on mattress; repeat 5 times.

Bathroom Safety Simulation

★★ Assisted

Practise balance strategies in a simulated bathroom (slippery mat, grab rail) environment.

1. Stand on bath mat, bare feet.
2. Simulate stepping over a low threshold.
3. Practise using a grab rail to lower to seated and rise.
4. Discuss home bathroom modifications.

Chair-to-Floor Transfer

★★★ Supported

Practise the controlled transfer from chair to floor and back to build floor-recovery confidence.

1. Sit at front of stable chair.
2. Slowly lower to kneeling, keeping one hand on chair.
3. Sit back to floor gently.
4. Rise via kneeling to standing using chair; repeat 3 times.

Gaze Stabilisation Walk

★★ Assisted

Focus eyes on a fixed target while walking to train vestibular-visual coordination.

1. Place a high-contrast target (X on paper) on wall at eye level.
2. Walk toward target, keeping eyes fixed on it.
3. Turn and walk away, maintaining gaze on target.
4. Repeat 4 lengths without losing focus.

Dual-Task Obstacle Walk

★★★ Supported

Navigate obstacles while counting backward to simulate demanding real-world conditions.

1. Set up 4 low obstacles on a 6-metre path.
2. Walk, stepping over or around obstacles.
3. Simultaneously count backward from 50 aloud.
4. Complete 3 passes; track errors.

Fear-of-Falling Discussion

★ Independent

Group discussion of fall fears and strategies to reduce fear-avoidance behaviour.

1. Sit in circle; facilitator introduces topic.
2. Each participant shares one situation they fear.
3. Group suggests practical strategies for each fear.
4. Record agreed strategies on whiteboard.

Home Hazard Review

★ Independent

Review a list of common home hazards and discuss how each can be removed or managed.

1. Provide a printed home hazard checklist.
2. Go through each item: loose rugs, trailing cables, poor lighting.
3. Participant marks present or absent for their home.
4. Discuss solutions and referral to OT if needed.

Wobble Cushion Training

★★ Assisted

Stand on an inflated wobble cushion to challenge proprioception and ankle stabilisers.

1. Place wobble cushion on floor near wall.
2. Step onto cushion, feet shoulder-width.
3. Hold still for 20 seconds.
4. Attempt eyes closed for 10 seconds.

Reactive Step with Partner

★★ Assisted

A partner calls a direction and participant immediately steps that way to train protective stepping reflexes.

1. Participant stands feet together.
2. Partner calls 'forward', 'back', 'left', or 'right' randomly.
3. Participant takes one large step in called direction.
4. Return to centre; 20 calls total.

Turning Balance Drill

★★ Assisted

Practise 180-degree turns repeatedly to build safe turning strategy.

1. Stand feet shoulder-width apart.
2. Turn 180 degrees using small pivot steps, not a spin.
3. Pause to confirm balance at completion.
4. Alternate turn direction; 10 turns each.

Escalator Readiness

★★ Assisted

Practise the grip, step-on, ride, and step-off sequence for escalator safety.

1. Use a stair with rail to simulate escalator.
2. Grasp rail firmly, take a confident step onto first stair.
3. Ride while holding rail.
4. Step off at top with confident stride.

Night Walk Simulation

★★ Assisted

Walk to bathroom in dim light simulating a night-time bathroom visit.

1. Darken corridor to simulate night.
2. Walk 6 metres to door and back using one hand on wall.
3. Discuss night-light placement strategies.
4. Repeat 3 times; discuss footwear.

Sit to Stand Power

★★ Assisted

Practise a faster sit-to-stand to build reactive strength for recovery stepping.

1. Sit at front of chair.
2. On 'Go', stand as quickly and safely as possible.
3. Rest 10 seconds.
4. Repeat 8 times; track time to stand.

Balance Catch Game

★★ Assisted

Catch and throw a ball while standing on one leg to combine balance and distraction tasks.

1. Stand on left leg, right hand near chair.
2. Partner throws a foam ball from 1.5 m.
3. Catch and throw back without putting down right foot.
4. 10 catches each leg.

Visual Conflict Balance

★★★ Supported

Wear mild prism glasses or side-vision reducers and walk to challenge visual dependency.

1. Participant wears mild vision-reducing glasses (or light gauze over lenses).
2. Walk 4 metres in clear corridor.
3. Therapist walks alongside; participant uses proprioceptive cues.
4. Remove glasses; discuss sensations.

Step-and-Reach Recovery

★★ Assisted

Deliberately shift weight forward until a step is needed, then take recovery step cleanly.

1. Stand feet together near wall.
2. Lean forward slowly until a step is unavoidable.
3. Take a firm recovery step forward.
4. Return and repeat 8 times each leg.